SimPaths Online: administrator guide

Ross Richardson · 3 November 2026

This guide explains how to administer SimPaths Online, manage account permissions and perform everyday checks. Scientific outputs are still experimental. The current shared training inputs come from the public SimPaths repository; admitting confidential provider data needs separate host-security and disclosure-control acceptance.

The user workflow is described in the User Guide. Use the maintainer guide for software and model releases. The detailed runbooks linked below remain the reference for recovery and capacity changes. Examples use fictional email addresses; substitute the exact approved address and dataset ID.

1. Access and responsibilities

Access	Address or route	What it permits
Ordinary MultiRun user	https://13.140.163.1	Emailed-code sign-in, owned experiments, permitted datasets and results
MultiRun administrator	https://13.140.163.1/admin	Separate password **and** emailed code; account and provider-dataset permission changes, status and change history
SingleRun administrator	https://13.140.163.1:8443/admin	Existing SingleRun password login and session/user controls
Host operator	SSH as `simpaths-admin`	Installed configuration, software, monitoring, backups, storage and recovery

The MultiRun administrator interface must first be installed and explicitly enabled by a host operator. An ordinary account, even one approved permanently, does not acquire administrator powers. Administrator email addresses can be added or removed by a host operator through the private server configuration. The MultiRun administrator webpage can manage ordinary user access, but cannot grant administrator privileges. The SingleRun and MultiRun administrator passwords and sessions are separate.

Keep passwords in a password manager and recovery credentials in a separate, secure backup location. Never send passwords, email codes, SMTP settings, database connection strings or backup private keys in feedback messages or screenshots.

2. Manage MultiRun accounts in the browser

Open **MultiRun administration** and enter your administrator email and the separate administrator password. Enter the code sent to that inbox. A sign-in code grants no authority unless the account is active and on the private administrator list. Sessions expire after 30 minutes; sign in again when needed. Sign out when finished. Administrator sign-out leaves an ordinary MultiRun session in the same browser signed in.

Under **Accounts**, search by email or part of an address. The list includes active, expired and revoked accounts. Select **Manage** to copy an address into the account form, or enter a new address directly.

To approve or renew an account:

1. Check the exact email address, including the domain.
2. Choose 30, 90 or 365 days, or **No expiry (revocable)**.
3. Select **Review approval / renewal**. Read the current permissions and the proposed change.
4. Select **Confirm change**, or **Cancel** to leave the account unchanged.

The chosen duration starts when confirmed. Renewal preserves the account's owner identity and remaining files; it does not restart stopped jobs or replenish their attempt/time limits. Browser

sessions still have their own expiry. An approval does not send an invitation or create a signed-in session: tell the recipient where to sign in, and they request their own emailed code.

To remove access, enter or select the address and choose **Review revocation**. Confirm only after checking the displayed target and consequences. Revocation invalidates existing user and administrator sessions and stops affected work promptly. It does **not** delete the user's data. The interface refuses revocation of your own signed-in administrator account; another administrator or the private operator command can do that.

Every confirmed interface change appears under **Change history**, with its administrator, target, time and before/after values. Repeating confirmation after a lost response reuses that same change rather than extending an approval twice. If another administrator has changed the target since review, review it again. History retains up to 10,000 interface changes for one year; captured history is also included in encrypted backups. Private CLI changes are outside this browser history, so preserve their private operator receipts separately.

Expiry, reminders and existing work

Finite approvals have reminders one calendar month and seven days before expiry. The messages ask users to request renewal; they do not renew an account. Permanent approvals have no expiry reminders and remain revocable.

Natural expiry prevents sign-in, reads, new submissions, queued starts and new attempts. An already admitted attempt can finish within the earlier of its original deadline and 48 hours after expiry. Renewal does not extend that attempt's frozen deadline. **Explicit revocation has no such grace period.** Capacity stays reserved until execution is confirmed stopped.

Files keep their normal retention dates after expiry or revocation. Renewal restores access only to files that still exist. Neither approval nor revocation resets retention or provides a permanent archive. There is no administrator "revoke and delete everything" button.

3. Manage provider dataset permissions

An account approval and a provider dataset grant are separate decisions. Use **Provider datasets**, enter an account email, and select **Show permissions**. Select **Manage grant** beside the intended restricted dataset, choose a duration or no expiry, and review and confirm the grant or revocation.

The account must be active before a new grant can be issued. Each grant applies to one user and one dataset. Different users can have different expiry dates for the same dataset; different datasets can have different user groups. Account renewal does not extend a separate dataset grant. A dataset grant does not keep an expired account active.

Public training inputs are automatically usable by every approved account and need no individual grant. They retain the provider-data boundary: MultiRun users receive aggregate products rather than downloadable raw training inputs or individual simulation output. A user's own uploads are private to that user and cannot be shared through this page. Mixing uploaded and provider inputs does not remove the provider restrictions; all contributing permissions must remain valid.

Dataset expiry or explicit revocation stops affected work promptly, without the account-expiry grace period. Other dataset grants are unaffected. Existing files keep their normal retention dates.

A grant permits use of data; it is not approval to release all derived outputs. Restricted-provider Visualiser output remains disabled until the dataset's disclosure rules are approved and implemented. Do not use account or dataset permissions to bypass this separate release condition.

4. Check service health and demand

Service status shows account totals, job states, held model/processing/SingleRun reservations, and the current CPU, RAM and job-storage budgets. It is read-only and refreshes every 30 seconds while open. "Available to batch" respects protected interactive and processing allowances; it is not the host's instantaneous idle CPU or free RAM. Job storage is a scheduler allowance, **not a measurement of how full the filesystem is**.

With the capacity-reporting update installed, this page also shows the last CPU/RAM capacity-check time, its freshness and recent capacity incidents. These checks normally run every five minutes;

readings older than 15 minutes are marked stale. The page's 30-second refresh does not itself take a new capacity reading. Compare detected capacity with the approved pool **plus** the service headroom, rather than with current usage. Failed readings are shown as unknown, with the last successful reading separately identified.

If you receive **host capacity needs attention**, use the incident reference to find the cause, first/last failure and recovery time on this page. A valid subsequent check can restore admissions automatically, so a healthy page an hour later does not mean the original warning was incorrect. A recovery email follows a warning that was sent; repeated failures within the same incident are grouped. A later separate recurrence gets a new incident reference. Recent resolved incidents remain visible. No restart or budget increase should be inferred from the warning alone. See capacity controls.

For a fuller check, connect from an authorized laptop:

```
ssh -i "$HOME/.ssh/simpaths_contabo_ed25519" simpaths-admin@13.140.163.1
```

Then, in the VPS terminal:

```
cd /opt/simpaths-online/SimPaths
sudo -u simpaths-online /opt/simpaths-online/venv/bin/python -B \
  -m deploy.multirun.vm_web status --config /etc/simpaths-online/multirun.toml
```

This read-only command does not migrate, launch jobs or send emails. Its private JSON form adds `--json`. It includes queue history, cleanup, resource accounting, retained releases and monitoring status. See operator status for field meanings and unavailable/stale readings.

Useful host checks are:

```
sudo systemctl status simpaths-executor simpaths-multirun \
  simpaths-singlerun-executor simpaths-singlerun --no-pager
df -hT
df -i
sudo systemctl list-timers --all --no-pager
```

Keep journals and JSON exports private. Inspect a relevant unit's recent journal with `sudo journalctl -u UNIT_NAME --since "1 hour ago" --no-pager`. A running Python service alone does not prove that sign-in, dispatch, charts or mail work; check the affected workflow too.

Monitoring and email

The installed performance monitoring samples every 15 seconds. Detailed model measurements and exports support resource tuning; lightweight host/service data also reveals outages, background load and storage pressure when no models run. Missing measurements are not proof of zero use. Review sampled peaks alongside failure receipts: a brief burst can occur between samples.

The configured administrator performance record is sent periodically and can arrive as several parts. Attachments contain numeric operational history, not raw scientific data or user addresses. Parts contain changes to cumulative records; their totals must not simply be added together. Save all parts and use the performance export importer to deduplicate and check missing parts. A test email proves that one delivery worked, not that later exports were delivered. Check the last successful send and pending/error state in the operator report.

The independent host capacity monitor checks mounted filesystems and inodes about every five minutes. It warns at 85% and clears below 80%, including for root, PostgreSQL, Docker, private data and backups. Treat a missing mount as a fault, not an empty disk. Do not delete Docker volumes or application directories to silence an alert.

5. SingleRun administration

Use the existing SingleRun administrator page for its active sessions, session termination and SingleRun-specific user controls. These controls do not approve a MultiRun account or grant a MultiRun dataset. The current service admits one interactive session at a time; users can request an availability email when busy. That email makes no reservation. Explicit **Leave** gives a five-minute notification delay; natural expiry can notify after cleanup finishes.

Ending a SingleRun session stops that user's interactive model. The user may see a disconnected-engine message until returning to the catalogue. Prefer normal **Leave** or the session control over killing Docker containers directly. The protected resource allowance is released only after cleanup is confirmed.

Changes to the number of interactive sessions, their RAM allowance or protected CPU need a reviewed shared-pool policy change. They can reduce MultiRun capacity unless the host is upgraded. Do not simply start a second unaccounted instance. Availability demand reports help determine whether more interactive capacity is needed; see `docs/singlerun-availability.md` in JAS-mineweb.

6. Retention and backups

The current ordinary MultiRun output retention is seven days after successful completion. Uploads, prepared inputs, aggregate charts and reusable summaries have their own lifetimes and dependency rules. Charts/summaries currently have separate seven-day settings, and eligible charts unused for 72 hours can be reclaimed under storage pressure. Check the dates shown to each user and the operator report; do not assume every artifact expires with its raw output. See the user-facing retention policy and Visualiser retention.

Owners can free space under **Storage → Output Files** using **Delete raw outputs, keep Visualiser data**. This requires complete, compatible summaries for every repetition; a ready chart alone is insufficient. If summaries are missing, prepare the charts first. The review states the permanent loss of raw files and the existing summary deadline. Confirmation preserves available charts and permits later baseline comparisons while the required summaries remain valid; it extends neither summary nor chart retention. New calculations needing the deleted raw files will no longer be possible. Check the resulting Storage status and usage.

The separate **Delete output files** action also withdraws hosted aggregate access. After raw-only deletion, this control is named **Delete results and Visualiser data**. Neither action recalls an aggregate ZIP already downloaded by a user. The administrator webpage has no user-data deletion control; operators should follow the reviewed lifecycle procedures rather than removing files directly.

Daily encrypted local backups and hourly retry checks are configured. The complete scheduled invocation has a **six-hour limit**, covering source-byte verification, database export, compression/encryption and ciphertext checks. This is a maximum, not an expected duration. A failed or unfinished capture does not replace the previous verified backup. Check completion status rather than treating a growing temporary file as a recovery copy.

A separate, small encrypted host-configuration copy preserves settings such as stable session secrets. Refresh it after configuration changes; the current copy includes the six-hour backup and three-hour chart limits. Online application backups retain settled files and database state; they are not a checkpoint of the Java engine's current in-memory state. SingleRun controls can be briefly protected while its recovery state is captured. An interrupted model is recovered or retried within its existing budgets.

The recovery private key and its passphrase stay outside the VPS. Keep the verified private-key export and key metadata in a separate secure location, along with downloaded encrypted recovery copies. Losing both the key and its usable export makes encrypted backups unrecoverable. A copy on the same VPS does not protect against loss of that VPS: an external backup destination remains to be configured. Keep the present local-retention policy until remote transfer, readback and isolated restoration have passed.

The administrator password **hash**, audit and permission state are included in application backups; the private administrator email list is in the host-configuration copy. Restored administrator sessions keep their original expiry. Restore does not extend approval dates, send mail or start applications. Review the restored policy and invalidate administrator sessions before reopening a recovered service when appropriate.

Use the backup runbook for status, capture, verification and inactive restore. Prove a restore using an isolated target, never over the running service. A "scheduled backup completed" recovery email can close a previous failed-backup incident; inspect the scheduler receipt to identify the capture.

7. Capacity, jobs and software changes

The scheduler shares work fairly between users and then uses available resources; it is not a promise of strict global first-in-first-out execution. CPU, RAM, storage, preparation dependencies and per-user limits can all delay admission. Resource settings and seeds are frozen when work is accepted. Small and large configurations use the qualified resource policy selected for their model release. Spare CPU may boost running models and can be reclaimed for interactive work or Visualiser preparation. Emergency growth/retries remain bounded by the original attempt, runtime and storage ceilings.

Each chart preparation currently has a **three-hour limit**, including source verification, aggregation, baseline comparisons and publication. Large outputs may need substantial time; this allowance is not a completion guarantee or an estimate of the wait. A chart-only retry reuses compatible retained per-repetition summaries and does not rerun simulations. CPU/RAM allowances, access checks and retention dates are unchanged by the longer time limit. See Visualiser preparation.

An upgraded host does not silently approve a larger shared CPU/RAM budget. Detection records spare capacity and can notify the administrator. Inspect its proposal, protected allowances and outside-pool headroom, then explicitly approve the increase through the compute capacity controls. Accepted jobs retain their frozen settings. The storage budget controls separately follow approved filesystem growth while preserving free-space headroom. Growing an XFS logical volume can be done online; shrinking it requires a planned migration. A provider upgrade can itself require a reboot, which interrupts running processes.

For updates, stage and qualify a matching frontend/model-adapter pair and preserve a verified recovery point. Use the tested reload procedure for the affected components. Schema changes need an idle MultiRun window and compatible code; maintenance responses explain an interruption but do not eliminate it. A private executor restart must preserve/reconcile running containers and reservations; do not replace it with ad hoc container stops or database edits. Public frontend changes can have a narrower reload scope. SingleRun should be preserved when the change does not require its restart.

New model versions are registered as immutable releases. Changing a default does not replace the version of an existing prepared dataset, accepted job or retry. Retain any old images and files still referenced by work or recovery records. Use release management and the maintainer guide; do not overwrite frozen scientific artifacts.

8. Private operator controls and administrator recovery

Browser administration deliberately omits raw file access, user-data deletion, model dispatch, pool resizing and backup restoration. The host operator retains the narrow command-line controls. For example, on the VPS:

```
cd /opt/simpaths-online/SimPaths
sudo -u simpaths-online /opt/simpaths-online/venv/bin/python -B \
  -m deploy.multirun.account_admin --config /etc/simpaths-online/multirun.toml \
  approve --email person@example.org --days 365
sudo -u simpaths-online /opt/simpaths-online/venv/bin/python -B \
  -m deploy.multirun.account_admin --config /etc/simpaths-online/multirun.toml \
  revoke --email person@example.org
```

`approve --permanent` gives revocable access without expiry. `list` lists accounts; `grant-dataset` and `revoke-dataset` accept `--email` and `--dataset`. These commands do not turn a user into an administrator, send mail or delete data. See account permissions.

Administrator roles are set in the private file `/etc/simpaths-online/multirun.toml`. The host operator edits it using the reviewed configuration/reload procedure:

```
[administration]
enabled = true
emails = ["first-admin@example.org", "second-admin@example.org"]
```

Addresses must be exact, lowercase and already approved ordinary accounts. No password belongs in TOML or source control. With the private MultiRun executor stopped in a planned maintenance window, create or rotate the credential through the private interactive prompt:

```
cd /opt/simpaths-online/SimPaths
sudo -u simpaths-online /opt/simpaths-online/venv/bin/python -B \
  -m deploy.multirun.administrator_config password \
  --config /etc/simpaths-online/multirun.toml
```

Use 16–256 characters. Enter it twice at the hidden prompts; never put it on a command line or pipe it into a script. The file is service-owned mode 0600 at `state/administrator-password.json`, containing a salted scrypt hash. It is not the SingleRun `ADMIN_PASSWORD`. The helper refuses to change it while the private executor is using the state. Restart through the qualified procedure afterwards. Changing the credential or administrator list invalidates old challenges and administrator sessions when the new configuration is loaded.

To invalidate administrator sessions immediately without changing ordinary user sessions or restarting jobs:

```
sudo -u simpaths-online /opt/simpaths-online/venv/bin/python -B \
  -m deploy.multirun.administrator_config invalidate-sessions \
  --config /etc/simpaths-online/multirun.toml
```

Removing an email from the administrator list requires the private service to reload that configuration. For immediate loss of all access, revoke its ordinary account instead; that also stops its work. Restore a mistaken revocation by explicitly approving the same address again. Old sessions remain invalid and stopped jobs require the normal reviewed retry workflow.

If a problem is unclear, first save its time, affected job/reference and private status/journal evidence. Check whether an update, backup, expiry or capacity alert explains it. Avoid repeated submissions, broad Docker pruning, manual SQL fixes and deleting files behind the retention system. Ask the maintainer to review the evidence before performing a destructive recovery.